

vertigo!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 652 December 2002 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Club nights are at Turnbull House,¹ on the first clear Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher² at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings, run with an iron fist jam by "Al" Presidente Lowrie, start with precision at 8.00 pm with club business. Talks kick-off on the whistle at 8.01 pm.



Not be missed December section night featuring legend Pat Deavoll's ice climbing exploits

8pm 2 December Section Night at Turnbull house. The speaker is the awesome ice climber Patricia Deavoll. She'll talk about Canadian water fall ice and her recent trip to the Alaskan Range. This is one of those section nights not to be missed. We will also be providing Christmas drinks and nibbles for all. No excuses!



Onwards and upwards, Nicole and Alan Mt Taranaki, AIC 2002

¹ On Bowen Street, squashed behind the Treasury on Number 1 the Terrace.

² On Molesworth Street, opposite Parliament.

Upcoming section night reminders

January

No section meeting (or newsletter!) in January

February

On February 3rd 2002 we are going to have our annual BBQ at Fergs with free entry for all. As an added attraction this year we have also hired the two adjacent indoor beach volley ball courts and we will be running avalanche transceiver training/practice/competitions in these simultaneously. Come along for a free night's climbing or come along to have a go or practice your transceiver search skills (transceivers will be provided).

March

In March we will be having another of our popular short talks nights. Contact Caroline (cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) if you have a few slides from your summer adventures that we should see.

April

In April it is our AGM and Richard Wesley.



As an Alpine Club member you can now climb at Fergs Rock and Kayak for only \$5 EVERY Monday night, and at any other time for only \$8 (usually \$12). Make sure you carry your card and that your membership is up to date.

For those who are interested, this is a potential saving of \$2,756.00 every year! Or, if you just climb once a week on a Monday, you will save \$364.00. This becomes a \$284.00 PROFIT after you pay your Alpine Club membership. At least enough for a weekend trip to The Bay (or maybe the mountain if you're of that persuasion).

This doesn't take into account the fact that you will all, of course, be at the 10 Section nights we have each year....

Cardetts move to Paradise

Phil Castle and Beth Burdett have escaped Wellington's vigorous climate and generally poxy rock and have moved to their new house in Golden Bay.

Rumours that they have climbing on their back doorstep are quite exaggerated - the nearest cliff is at least 15 paces away.

They'd love to see friends from Wellington, and have space for lots of tents (except during the 3-week silly Christmas season, when they are already booked up!).

Their address is: Bay Vista Drive, Pohara. Email: philnbeth@paradise.net.nz. Phone: (03)525-6224.

Our website

Reminder about our web site www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

DISCUSSION GROUP - Over half of Wellington section members are now subscribed to our free email discussion group. If you would like to get or communicate articles of interest, trip details and other information then go to our web site www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for instructions on how to join.



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Richard Wesley
NZAC Administrator
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594
e mail office@alpineclub.org.nz



Climbing wall deals: More guilty pleasures

Reminder that Hangdog are continuing their anytime \$8 deal.

Editorial shake-out

ALONG WITH A FRIEND, I NEARLY DIED ON SUNDAY.

WE WERE PRACTICING A RESCUE SCENARIO ON THE TOP OF "SMALLPOX" AT WHANGANUI BAY. I'D CAREFULLY SET UP A BOMBER THREE POINT ANCHOR UNDER THE EYE OF OUR INSTRUCTOR CHRIS, CLIPPED IN TO BECOME PART OF THE SYSTEM, AND SUCCESSFULLY USED AN ASSISTED HOIST TO GET MY FRIEND AND COLLEAGUE MEL BACK UP TO THE TOP.

MEL WAS JUST ABOUT TO LOWER ME OFF THE EDGE TO PREPARE FOR HER PRACTICE HOIST WHEN CHRIS ASKED HER TO STOP. HER KRAB CONNECTING HER TO THE TERMINAL POINT AND THROUGH HER TO ME VIA THE ROPE WAS CLIPPED INTO ONE OF HER GEAR LOOPS, RATED TO HOLD 50 KG, RATHER THAN THE RIGHT PLACE, HER TIE IN LOOP. NOW, I'M NOT A BIG BOY, BUT I DO TIP THE SCALES AT SOMEWHAT MORE THAT

50KG. THE MOST LIKELY OUTCOME WAS FOR THE GEAR LOOP TO SNAP AND FOR BOTH ME AND MEL FALL ABOUT 15 METRES - VERY RAPIDLY - AND END UP SOMEWHAT THE WORSE FOR WEAR ON THE FOREST FLOOR. OUCH.

THE LESSONS? FIRST, VERY WELL SPOTTED BY CHRIS, OUR INSTRUCTOR. MANY HUMBLE THANKS. SECOND, I'D SET UP AND CAREFULLY CHECKED OUR ANCHOR SYSTEM, BUILDING IN REDUNDANCY. BUT MEL WAS AN INTEGRAL PART OF THE SYSTEM AND THERE WAS NO REDUNDANCY AT THE POINT SHE CLIPPED IN. I'D CHECKED EVERYTHING ELSE BUT I HADN'T CHECKED HER. SHE HADN'T CLIMBED FOR OVER A YEAR AND WAS FEELING A BIT RUSTY, ANOTHER GOOD REASON FOR ME TO CHECK. A BIT OF PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY THERE. I'LL TAKE THAT INTO THE FUTURE.

FUNNILY ENOUGH, NEITHER MEL NOR I WAS KEEN ON CLIMBING ANY FURTHER THAT DAY. BREATHING OXYGEN WAS AN EXCITING ENOUGH PURSUIT TO SEE OUT THE AFTERNOON.



Having fun? Share it with us!

Tell us what you are doing out there – we wanna to hear about what everyone is doing out there. Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz so everyone can enjoy your stories. That's YOU!!!



For sale: Women's plastics

Selling New-never-been-worn LOWA women's size 6 plastic boots for narrow feet.

Contact Erin Newton, 021 102 2670, erinclimbs@hotmail.com



And here are the club trips!

30/1 December 2002

A group is heading up to Mangatepopo/Whanganui Bay/Wharepapa both these weekends. Contact the trip co-ordinator.

7/8 December – Taranaki trip

Still plenty of snow for some pre alpine training. Going up via Dawson Falls/Fanthams Peak. Overnight Saturday at Syme hut. Contact: Tom Zink
Ph: 495 9772, Mob: +64 21 701 267, E-mail: tom.zink@contact-energy.co.nz.

27 December – 12 January 2003 - Aspiring Region

Interest in the trip to this area is strong, with rock climbers among the party for some excellent cragging on offer in the region. To lodge your intentions email Steve at sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, or phone 04-9738079

6-11 January 2003 - National Climbing Camp. Godley Valley.

Canterbury/Westland Section is organising the next national climbing camp. Centred at Separation Stream in the Godley Valley. Climbing possibilities include D'Archiac and Sybald. They are organising 4wd for access, or it's a one day walk to Godley hut. For more info contact NZAC HQ or see: http://www.nzalpine.org.nz/site_pages/main_navigation_bar/activities/climbing_camps.htm

Easter 2003 18th to 27th April 2003 - Wilkin Valley Exploration,

Easter Weekend and ANZAC day = only 3 days leave for 9 days away!

There are a host of peaks around the area to satisfy a range of skills. The Wilkin Valley is in Aspiring National Park. Objectives could include Castor, Pollux, Alba. Easy tramping is available. Please show your interest early, because transport booking has to be made well in advance.

Contact: Don French don.f@xtra.co.nz. phone: 06 377 7117

Queens Birthday Weekend 2003 – The Inland Kaiakouras

A chance to taste early winter snow in the inland Kaiakouras. Kevin Patterson is planning to get to Tapeaonuku next June. To get in quick with your place contact him at: Kevin.Patterson@nzmp.com, ph:04 566 0975

Post Monsoon 2004 (September/October)

How about a slightly longer trip - to Nepal? Several people have indicated interest in a section climbing trip to attempt several trekking peaks, Island Peak and Lobuje East have been suggested as reasonably straightforward objectives. This could include a non-climbing trek party also. Trip leaders for both are emerging as discussions go on. To indicate an initial interest email the trip co-ordinator, trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

Other Sections trips

Don't forget there are other sections of the NZAC out there. Check out there trips by going onto the main website www.nzalpine.org.nz and clicking on the individual section newsletters.

Thanks to everyone making an effort to generate club trips. Remember, trips can be any length, any level of difficulty and any size (a trip of two people is just as valid as a trip of ten). We have a trip template and plenty of suggestions for those who want to give it a go. Do contact me even if you want ideas for private trips. Nothing will be set in stone! sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, or phone 04-9738079



Wellington Section Directory: 2002 contact list

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